“Maybe it’s not allowed.”

It was almost as if they’d switched places. Rose had become the elder sister, bringing Maître Mallon to help Léa. She knew it couldn’t be easy for Rose, who avoided conflict and tense situations, preferring to be alone with her sketchbooks. Though Léa loved Rose for trying, she knew there was nothing Maître Mallon or anyone could do to get her out of here.

“Thank you both for coming,” Léa said, trying to put on a brave face.

“How are you holding up?” Maître Mallon asked.

Thinking of last night’s struggle to find a bed and the young woman’s body on the stretcher this morning, Léa tried to hold herself together. She hoped Rose wouldn’t see the strain on her face. Wanting to lessen their worry, she chose her words with care. “The camp is complicated. There aren’t enough beds or food. I don’t know why they put me here.”

“Maître Mallon knows,” Rose blurted out, rubbing her hands on her thighs.

Lacing his fingers into a tight ball, Maître Mallon leaned forward. “After Rose came to me,” he said, “I went early this morning to police headquarters. Your case is already closed. The black marketeer, in return for lenient treatment, pointed you out from the photo in your identification papers as the woman who helped him smuggle wine.” He took a breath. “I’m sorry to inform you that Édouard LeBlanc was executed following a conviction by a German military tribunal. Weinführer Brucker recommended the Jargeau camp as a suitable place for you to serve out your sentence.”

“Édouard’s dead?” Léa bent forward, straining to breathe. Was it her fault? She looked at Rose. “Because of the smuggling?”

“They said he was working with the Resistance,” Rose added.

Léa felt cold and numb inside. “He deserved a trial, a chance to defend himself. Poor Virginie and Paulette—tell them I’m so sorry.”

“They’re suffering terribly but they’re also strong.” Rose reached across the table and took her sister’s hand. “And you need to be too.”

“You said my sentence has already been decided.”

Maître Mallon glanced at Rose, then turned back to Léa. “A year.”

It suddenly felt as if all the air had been yanked from her lungs. But what had she expected? They’d murdered Édouard. Maybe she was lucky to get one year. She thought of Simone, the woman in cabin M, who hadn’t